

▽ Women warriors of Dahomey



1645

FIRST KING OF DAHOMEY

In the 1600s, the Fon people of West Africa formed the powerful state of Dahomey. Coming to the throne in 1645, Houegbadja is regarded as Dahomey's first king. He set up the state's characteristic institutions, including its corps of women warriors, who were called *Mino* ("Our Mothers"). Dahomey traded extensively with Europeans on the coast through the following century.

1645

1645 At the Battle of Naseby

in the English Civil War, Royalist forces are defeated by Parliament's New Model Army

1648 The Manchu Qing

dynasty extends its rule into southern China, taking Guangzhou

1647 Jesuits are branded subversives and expelled from the Massachusetts Bay colony

1648 Ottoman sultan Ibrahim is overthrown and replaced by his six-year-old son Mehmed IV

▽ The Manchu queue



1645

WEARING THE QUEUE

Having seized Beijing, the Manchu fought to impose their foreign rule on the Chinese. The populations of whole cities were massacred for continuing to support the deposed Ming. As a sign of submission, all Chinese men were ordered to adopt a Manchu hairstyle, with the front of the head shaved and a pigtail. The punishment for refusal of the "queue" was death.



1600-49 KING CHARLES I

King of England and Scotland from 1625, Charles believed in his divine right to rule. His marriage to Catholic Henrietta Maria and refusal to compromise on religion or politics led to his downfall.

1649

EXECUTION OF CHARLES I

Defeated in the English Civil War, Charles I was a prisoner of the Parliamentarians. After the failure of a Royalist uprising, supported by the Scots, in 1648, power lay with Oliver Cromwell and the New Model Army. On Cromwell's orders, the king was charged with treason. After a show trial, he was executed in Whitehall, London, on 30 January 1649. England became a republic for the next 11 years.



▷ Charles I is led to his execution